

The script of the inscriptions

At Sanchi – Brahmi

At Kandahar – Greek and Aramaic

At North Western part – Kharoshthi

The Rock Edicts II and XIII of Ashoka refer to the names of the three dynasties namely Pandyas, Cholas, the Keralaputras and the Sathyaputras.

Mauryan Administration

Centralized administration

King

- The king was the supreme and sovereign authority of the Mauryan Empire.
- Council of ministers known as *mantriparishad* assisted the King. Assembly of ministers included a Purohit, a Senapathi, a Maha mantri and the Yuvaraja.
- King had an excellent spy system.

Revenue system

- The land was the most important source of revenue for the state. Ashokan inscription at Lumbini mentions *bali and bagha* as taxes collected from people. The land tax (bhaga) collected was 1/6 of the total produce.
- Revenue from taxes on forests, mines, salt and irrigation provided additional revenue to the government.
- Much of the State revenue was spent on paying the army, the officials of the royal government, on charities and on different public works such as irrigation project, road construction etc.

Judicial System

- The king was the head of the Judiciary. He was the highest court of appeal.
- King appointed many judges subordinate to him. The punishments were harsh.

Military Administration

The king was the supreme commander of the army.

A board of 30 members divided into six committees with five members on each, monitored

- Navy
- Armoury (transport and supply)
- Infantry
- Cavalry
- The war chariots
- The war elephants

VI History - Lesson 3.indd 131 11-07-2019 2.38.07 PM